

Write Them Down

Second, your goals need to be written down, not just floating around in your head. If they're in your head, they're still hopes and dreams; they don't really become goals until you take the bold step of putting them on paper. That simple act has a huge payoff, too. Dr. Gail Matthews, a psychology professor who conducted a research study on goal setting, found that we are 42% more likely to achieve our goals just by writing them down.^{[24](#)} There's something about the act of putting goals down on paper that instantly gives a sense of accountability and commitment. It's as though we're taking our dreams out of the clouds and bringing them into the real world. And once they're *real*, it's up to us to go about the hard work of making them happen.